

Toddler impulse control intervention guide with daycare communication strategies — Action Checklist

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CONTAIN THE DAYCARE CRISIS

- ☐ **Contain the Daycare Crisis:** Send a written message to your provider that acknowledges the situation, signals your partnership commitment, and requests a structured re-entry meeting within seven days to stop the relationship from deteriorating further.
- ☐ **Contain the Daycare Crisis:** Request a 45-minute re-entry meeting with your provider to build a shared support plan rather than continuing to show up reactive and apologetic at pickups, which signals you are organized and serious about solving this.
- ☐ **Contain the Daycare Crisis:** Bring a one-page meeting agenda that includes an opening team statement, a section for the provider to share her observations, your home intervention updates, and a co-regulation plan with specific agreed scripts.
- ☐ **Contain the Daycare Crisis:** Set a written 30-day review date on the calendar before leaving your first meeting so you have an explicit accountability checkpoint with defined boundaries and milestones for assessing progress.

BUILD HOME INTERVENTION SKILLS

- ☐ **Build Home Intervention Skills:** Practice daily impulse control response scripts with your toddler repeatedly so their brain builds the neural pathways that allow them to stop before acting, which is the actual mechanism that changes behavior.
 - ☐ **Build Home Intervention Skills:** Use co-regulation by staying calm during biting incidents and verbally walking your toddler through the feeling and the alternative response, which teaches them to manage big emotions before they escalate.
 - ☐ **Build Home Intervention Skills:** Track incident report patterns by noting time of day, preceding activities, transitions, and emotional triggers so you can address root causes rather than just managing surface-level behavior.
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- ☐ **Build Home Intervention Skills:** Establish consistent response language at home that mirrors what the daycare uses so your toddler hears the same scripts in both environments, which accelerates their learning and reduces confusion.

PROTECT YOUR FAMILY FOUNDATION

- ☐ **Protect Your Family Foundation:** Schedule a dedicated conversation with your partner to share the action plan and agree on how you will handle pickups without defensiveness or blame, which prevents incident report stress from poisoning your marriage.
- ☐ **Protect Your Family Foundation:** Identify one non-negotiable weekly recharging activity for yourself such as exercise, a hobby, or a support group meeting because your emotional stability directly impacts your ability to respond calmly to your toddler.
- ☐ **Protect Your Family Foundation:** Set boundaries around childcare stress conversations by scheduling specific times to discuss updates rather than letting every dinner become a debrief of incident reports, which protects your relationship with your partner.
- ☐ **Protect Your Family Foundation:** Keep a brief daily log of what is working, even small progress, because seeing forward momentum prevents the spiral of feeling like nothing will ever improve, and that focus breeds endurance.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.